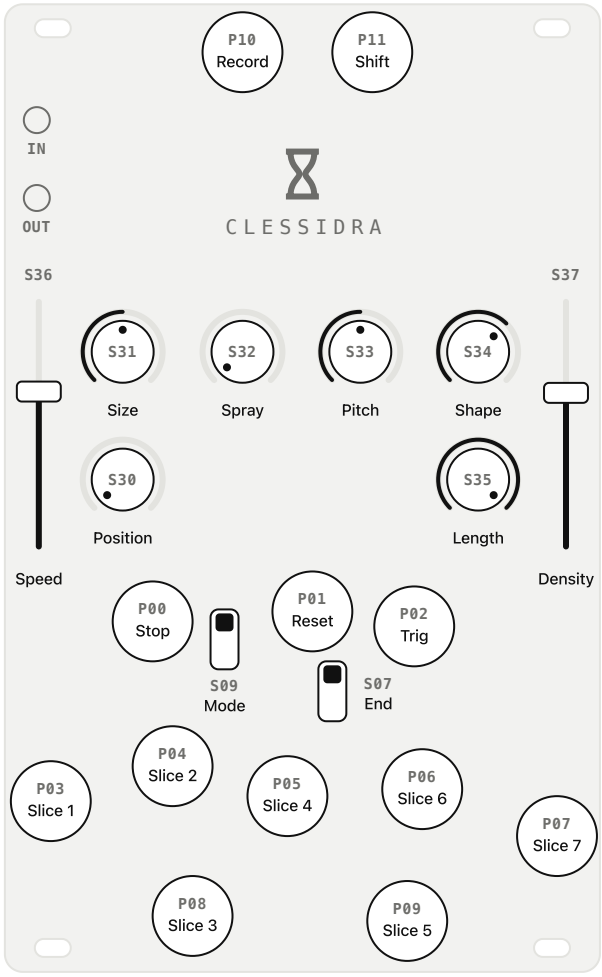
Simple Touch

# Clessidra

It's the instrument where you pour grains of sound from single drops into a dense cloud.

francescodimaggio.nl/clessidra

Synthux Design Residency 2026




Record a sound, then play it as grains: Speed through it, Density how they fall.

Two layers: each knob alone, and its twin with P11 held. Nothing jumps when they change.

Density at the bottom: no grains but the slices'. S09 at its centre: frozen.

## FADERS AND KNOBS

| | |
|---|---|
| S36 | **Speed**. Playback speed, 0 to 4×. The pitch stays. Frozen: scrubs the loop.<br>*P11*: **Volume**. Output level. |
| S37 | **Density**. Grains per second, 0 to 320.<br>*P11*: **Random timing**. From a regular pulse to random. |
| S30 | **Position**. Loop start.<br>*P11*: **Filter**. Low-pass below the centre, high-pass above. |
| S35 | **Length**. Loop length.<br>*P11*: **Reverb**. None to long. |
| S31 | **Size**. Grain length, 5 ms to 2 s.<br>*P11*: **Random size**. Each grain a different length. |
| S32 | **Spray**. Grains scatter around the playhead and across the stereo field.<br>*P11*: **Reverse**. How many grains play backwards. |
| S33 | **Pitch**. Two octaves either way, with stops at intervals.<br>*P11*: **Random pitch**. Octaves below the centre, free above. |
| S34 | **Shape**. Grain envelope: square, decay, bell, reverse.<br>*P11*: **Random shape**. Each grain a different envelope. |

## PADS AND SWITCHES

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|---|---|
| S09 | **Mode**. Forward, freeze, reverse. |
| S07 | **End**. At the loop's end: once, turn or loop. |
| P10 | **Record**. Tap: keeps the last 8 s. Hold: records up to 30 s. With Shift: listen. |
| P11 | **Shift**. Hold for each knob's second function. |
| P00 | **Stop**. Tape stop. Touch again to start. |
| P01 | **Reset**. Second functions back to default. |
| P02 | **Trig**. The loop from its start, now. Starts it when stopped. |
| P03–P09 | **Slices**. The loop in seven slices: its start, then the recording's strongest attacks inside it. Without attacks, as in a held note, even parts. Left to right on the board: P03, P04, P08, P05, P09, P06, P07. Held: plays its slice in the direction S09 sets, to its end as S07 sets. Several at once. The loop waits. |

## TO PLAY

| | |
|---|---|
| Rhythm | Density low, Random timing (P11 + S37) down, Shape on decay, Size short. Size sets how long each hit lasts |
| Drops | Density near the bottom, Size short: single grains, now and then |
| Drums by hand | Density at the bottom, Shape on square: tap the slices, several at once |
| Cloud | Density at the top, Size 150 to 300 ms, Shape on bell, Spray up, Random timing (P11 + S37) full, Reverb (P11 + S35) up |
| Stretch | Speed at ¼ or ½, Density up. S09 down to hear it backwards |
| Drone | S09 at the centre, Density at the top, Size long, a little Spray, Reverb up. Speed scrubs the point |
| One pour | S07 down: the loop plays once and stops. Trig pours it again |
| Shimmer | Random pitch (P11 + S33) below the centre: octaves |
| Backwards syllables | Reverse (P11 + S32) at the top: the phrase in order, each grain backwards |

## LED

| | |
|---|---|
| Glow | Grains falling |
| Flashing | Recording |
| Pulse | At a stop: unison, speed 1×, 100 ms, filter off, random pitch off |

| | |
|---|---|
| `Steady` | P11 held: the twin last turned |